

# Components and objectives of data governance

So far, you've learned about data governance, and its components and goals. Data governance is a process that ensures the formal management of a company's data. Organizations need data governance to keep their data accurate, reliable, and safe. Otherwise, the data can become overwhelming, difficult to access, and make drawing important insights more challenging. Implementing and maintaining consistent data governance ensures that the data your stakeholders need is useful and error-free. In this reading, you'll review the components and goals of data governance, and explore examples of data governance in practice.

## Components of data governance

Data governance has four essential elements: data policies and standards, data quality management, data privacy and security, and data stewardship and ownership. Each of these components is a necessary part of designing and implementing effective data governance. Review the chart to learn more about each of these components:

| Component                 | Definition                                                                                 | Example                                                                                                                      |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Policies and standards    | The rules, guidelines, and procedures for data management within an organization           | A retail company sets guidelines for how long they retain customer data before it's deleted to optimize storage resources    |
| Quality management        | Maintaining the accuracy, completeness, consistency, and reliability of data               | A data analytics team constructs a pipeline that automatically checks and cleans data before it's ingested into the database |
| Privacy and security      | Implementing security protocols, access controls, and compliance with data protection laws | A medical technology company anonymizes data to protect patient privacy                                                      |
| Stewardship and ownership | The assignment of roles and responsibilities for data management and oversight             | A data analytics team lead develops an organizational guide assigning data responsibilities                                  |

## Goals of data governance

Data governance has three primary goals: achieve data integrity and accuracy; establish policies and practices that align with regulations, and protect privacy rights; and make data more accessible and usable for authorized users. In an organization, these goals can align with important business objectives. Review the chart for an overview of these primary goals:

| Goal                                                                                     | Implementation                                                                                                                                         | Example                                                                                                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Achieve data integrity and accuracy throughout the data lifecycle                        | By implementing data quality controls and validation processes, organizations can ensure that data is trustworthy and reliable.                        | A weather station ingesting live data uses data validation processes to ensure their data is clean and error-free as it arrives           |
| Establish policies and practices that align with regulations, and protect privacy rights | Data governance ensures an organization is complying with current data privacy standards.                                                              | A fitness tracker device company follows specific guidelines to protect users' data                                                       |
| Make data more accessible and usable for authorized users                                | By implementing proper data classification, access controls, and metadata management, data can become more accessible and usable for authorized users. | A financial firm adds sheet-level permissions so authorized users can access the data they need without interacting with the live sources |

## Key takeaways

Data governance is a must-have for any organization dealing with data. It's the best way to ensure that data is accurate, reliable, and secure. As a cloud data professional, understanding the components and goals of data governance will help you design and implement your own data governance protocols in the future, and align with your organization's current governance.